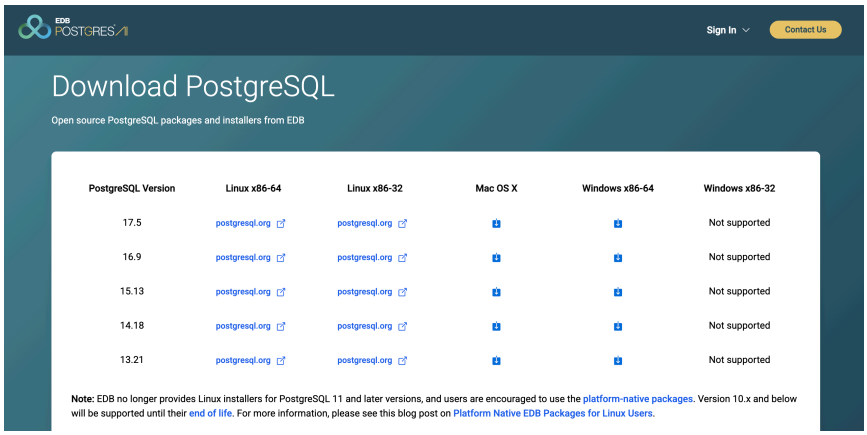
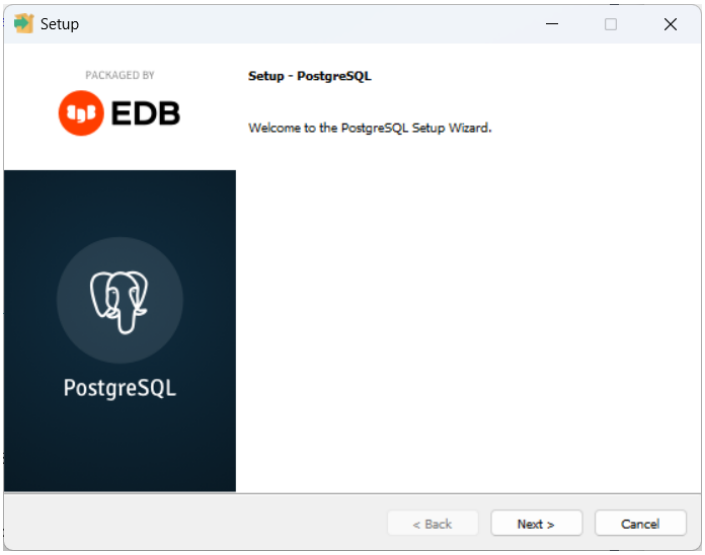
Installation Guide

1. Go to https://www.enterprisedb.com/downloads/postgres-postgresql-downloads.



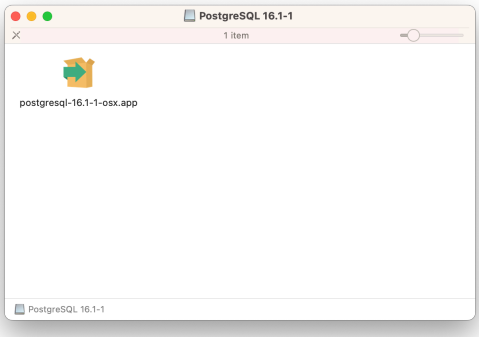
2. Select the ***latest***[1] version of PostgreSQL for your OS (where "`X-X-X`" indicates the version):
   - For "Windows x86-64", the file is "`postgresql-X.X-X-windows-x64.exe`".
   - For "Mac OS X", the file is "`postgresql-X.X-X-osx.dmg`".
3. Double-click on the file once the download is finished.

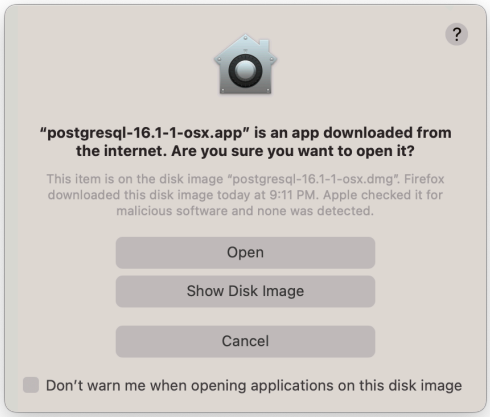
Windows For Windows, you may need to enter the *username* and *password* for an **administrator account**. You will be greeted with the following screen.



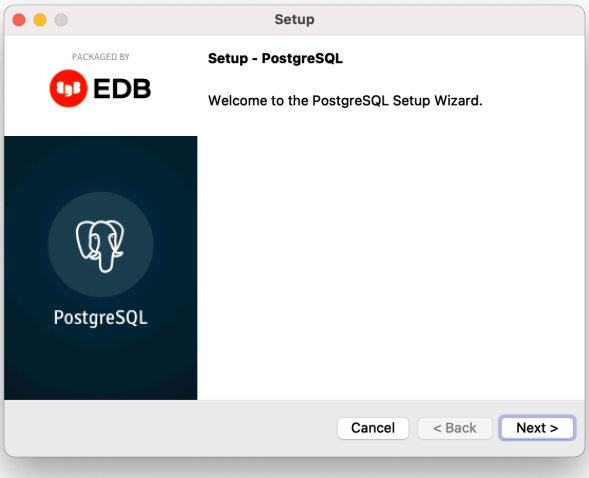
[1] Our latest version is version 17

Mac OS X For Mac OS X, it will mount a drive with "`postgresql-X.X-X-osx.app`". Double click on the file and click "Open" when presented with the warning on the right.

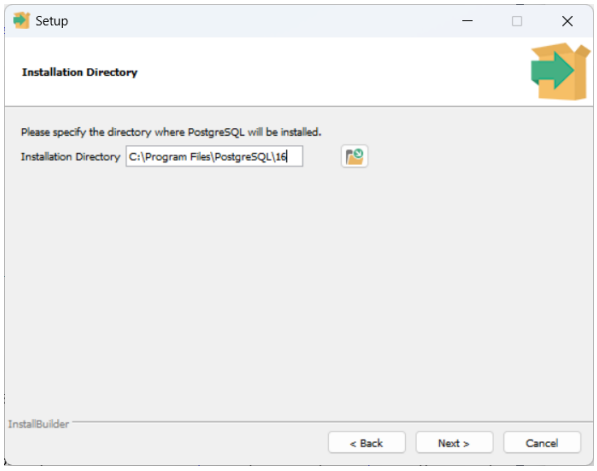


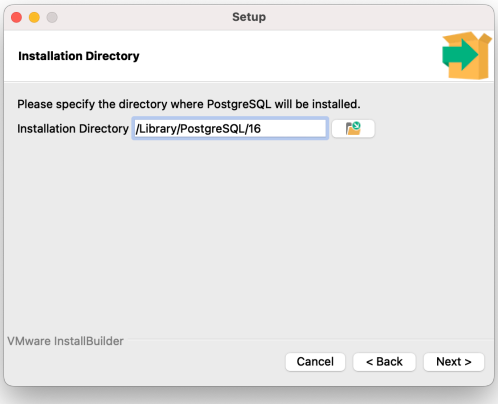


You may need to enter the *username* and *password* for an **administrator account**. You will then be greeted with a similar screen as for Windows.

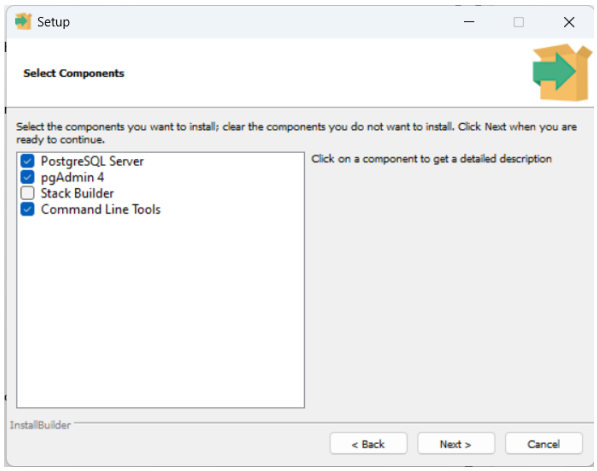


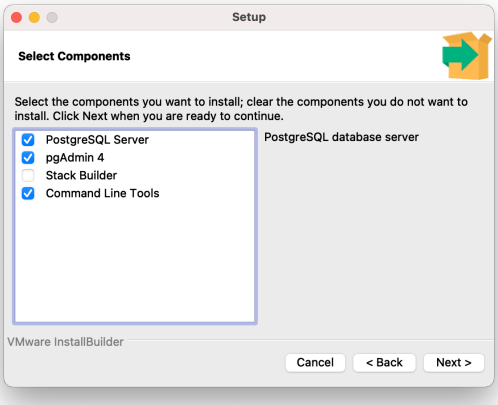
4. Click "`Next`". Specify the installation directory. We would recommend using the default installation directory.



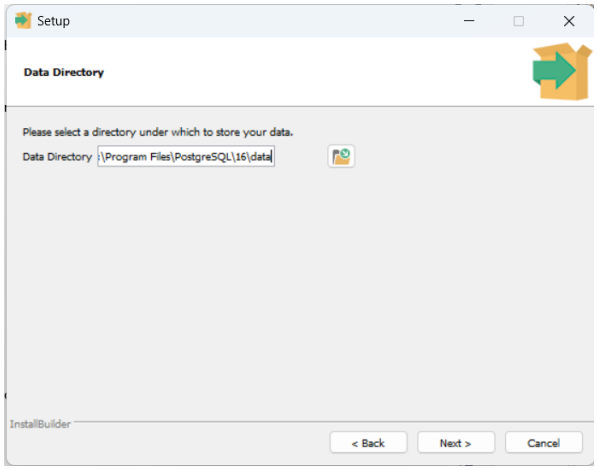


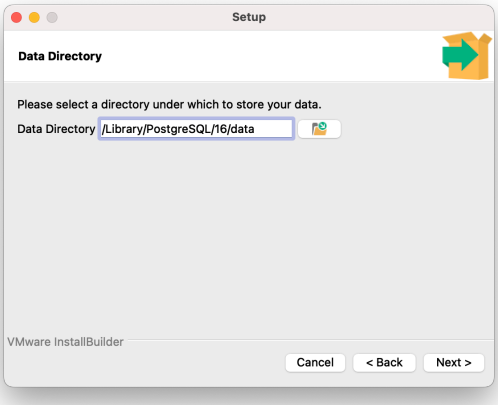
5. Click "`Next`". You may choose what to install. We would recommend the following: (1) PostgreSQL Server, (2) pgAdmin4 (*or other version*), and (3) Command Line Tools (*this is psql*)





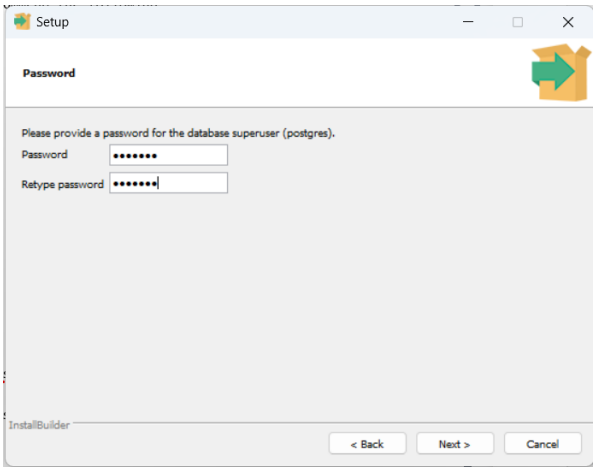
6. Click "`Next`". Specify the directory to store your data. We would recommend using the default directory.

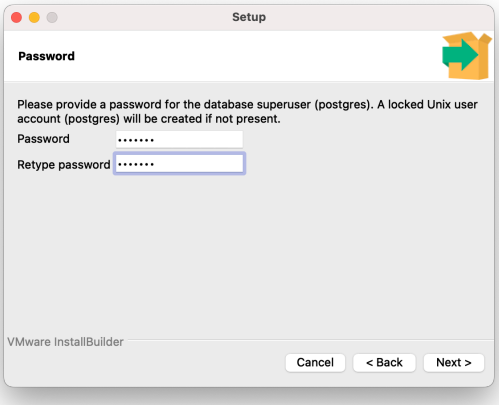




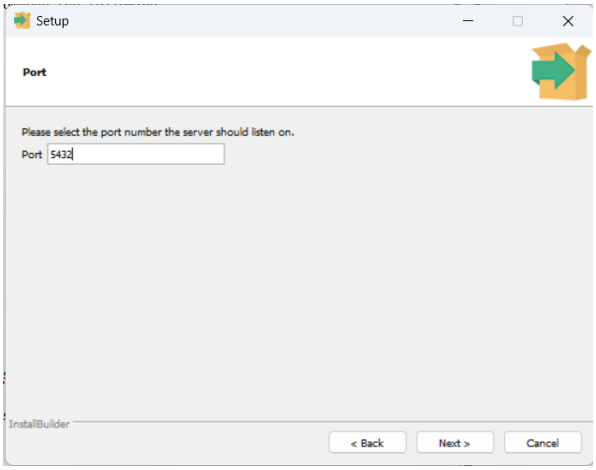
7. Click "`Next`". Specify the password for superuser `postgres`.

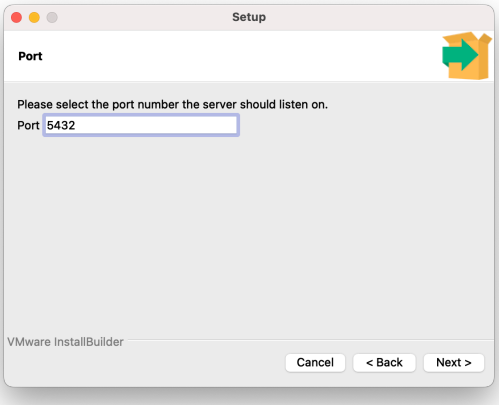
> **NOTE**
> *Please remember this password as you will need it to access your database in* ***Step 3*** *of using psql!*



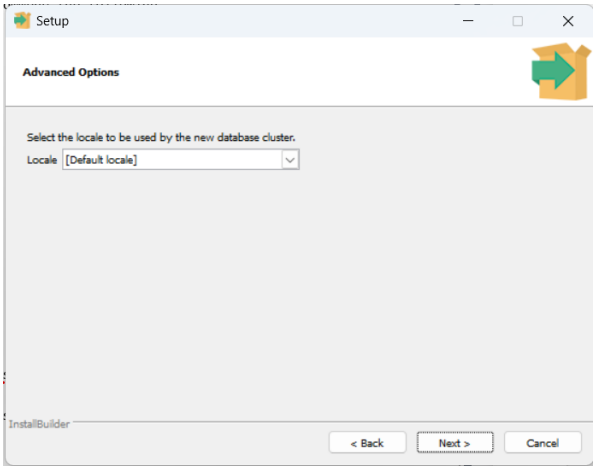


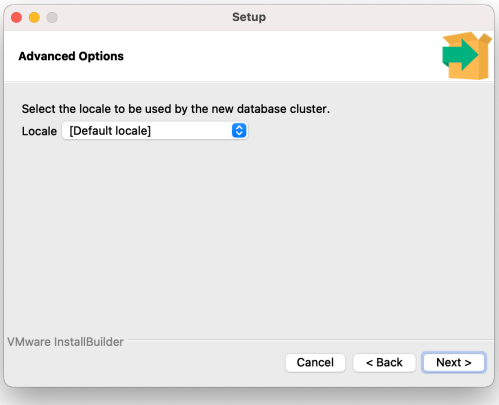
8. Click "`Next`". Specify the port number. We would recommend using the default `5432`.



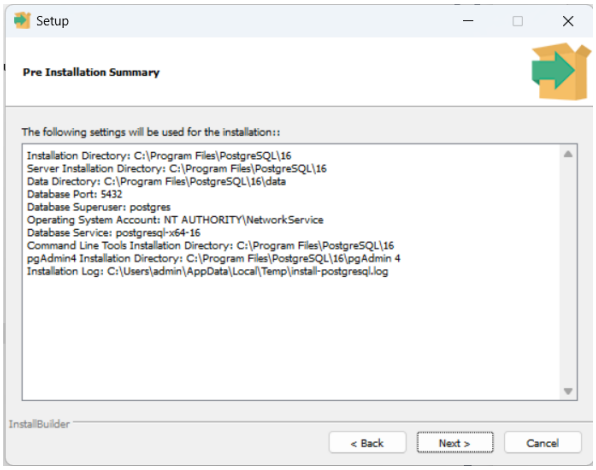


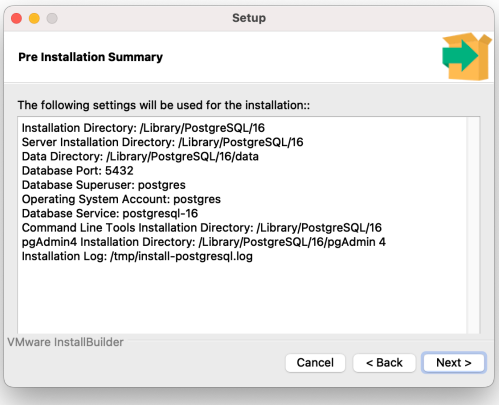
9. Click "`Next`". Specify the locale. We would recommend using the default setting.



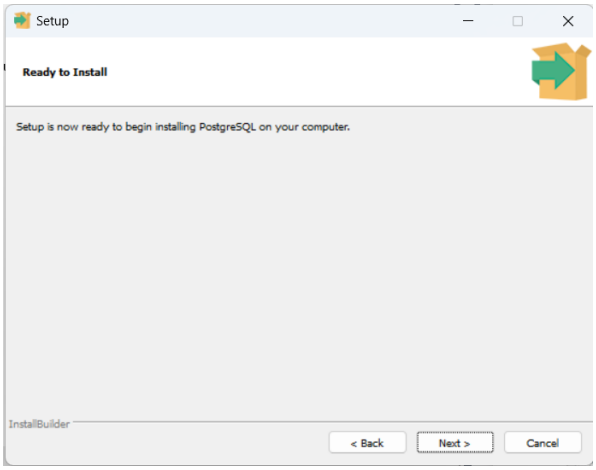


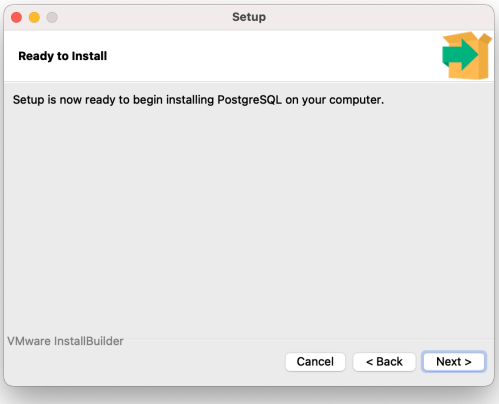
10. Click "`Next`". Review the installation setting.



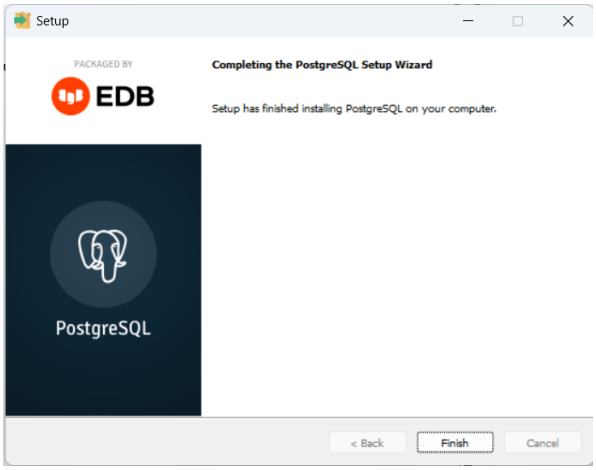


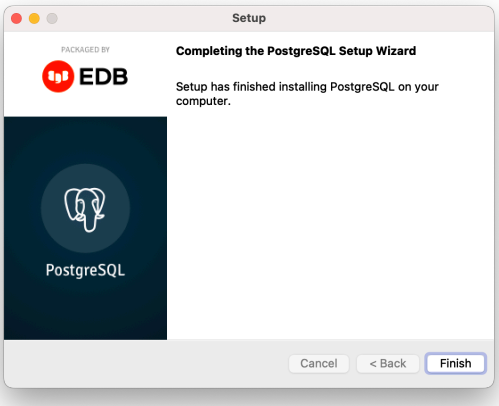
11. Click "`Next`". You are now ready to install PostgreSQL.





12. Click "`Next`" and wait for the installation to complete.





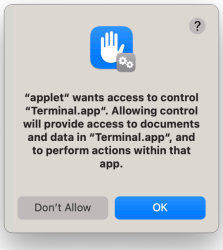
13. Click "`Finish`" to complete the installation.

NOTE
If you have selected to install "`Stack Builder`", you may have additional steps.

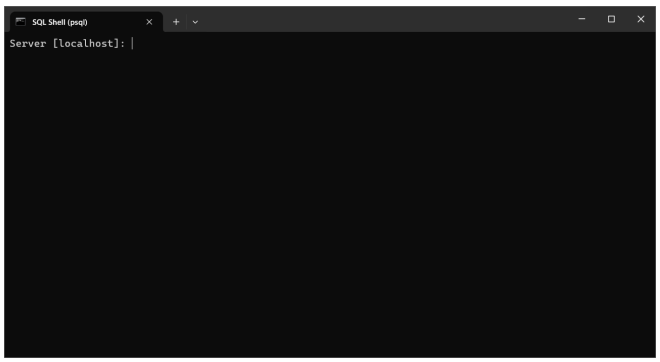
psql

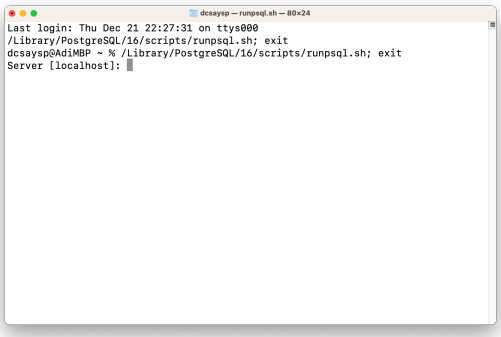
1. Search for "`SQL Shell (psql)`". Click on it to open psql.

> *If you are using Mac OS X and this is your first time opening psql, you may be greeted with the message shown on the right. Simply click "`OK`".*



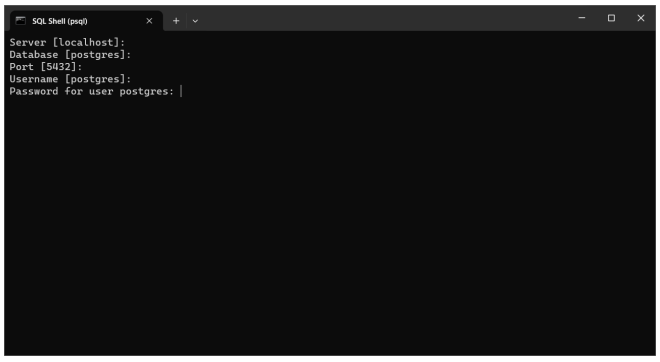
2. Simply use the default setting by clicking "`Enter`".

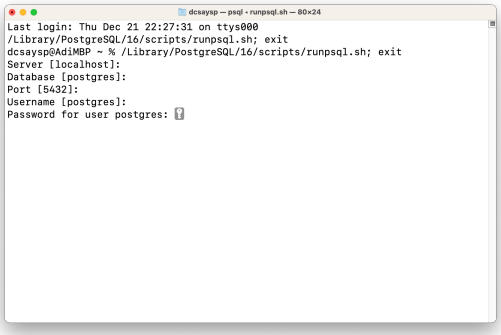




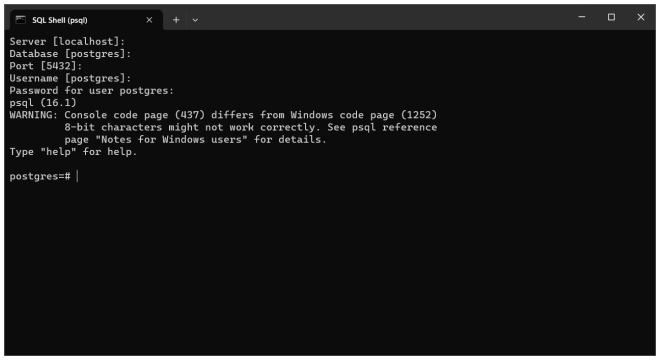
3. You will be prompted for *password*. Use the password you specified in **Step 7**. Press "`Enter`" once you keyed in your password.

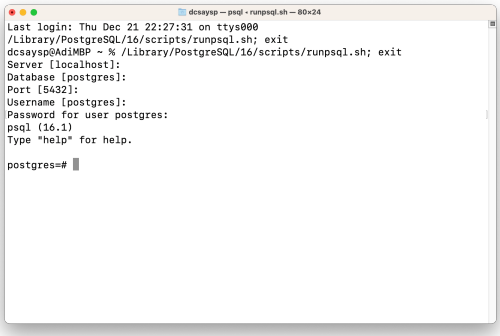
> **NOTE**
> *Remember, this is the postgresql user password and not your Windows/Mac user account.*





4. Welcome to psql!





In case your Mac cannot find the installed files

In some cases, macOS may not know the location of your installed PostgreSQL files by default. This usually happens when the `psql` command is not in your system's PATH. To fix this, follow these steps:

1. Locate the PostgreSQL bin folder (usually it is as follows):
   `/Library/PostgreSQL/17/bin`

2. Add it to your PATH:
   ```
   echo 'export PATH="/Library/PostgreSQL/17/bin:$PATH"' >> ~/.bash_profile
   source ~/.bash_profile
   ```

   (Replace 17 with your actual version if needed)

3. Start psql:
   ```
   psql -U postgres
   ```